

KT with Chen

Title: Onboarding: Deep Dive into the Auth Service Participants: Marcus Chen (Leader), Two New Engineers
Duration: 60 minutes

(Transcript Start)

Marcus Chen: "Welcome to the Auth Team. I'm Marcus, a Senior Backend Engineer. Today, we're covering the core Auth Service. It started life as a small feature inside the monolith back in 2019, but we extracted it in 2022 to improve scaling. The key technical decision was choosing JWTs over session tokens because of better mobile app compatibility. You might see the `legacy_auth` database table still floating around—that's for migration edge cases; don't touch it. On the product side, the big thing to remember is the difference between our user base: we support SAML and OIDC for enterprise, but we still don't have LDAP support for government contracts—that's a known gap in the roadmap."

New Engineer 1: "Where should we check for oncall rotation?"

Marcus Chen: "Good question. Oncall rotates weekly; check the `#auth-oncall` Slack channel. Also, any token policy changes need sign-off from Legal. Now, for troubleshooting, if you hit a token refresh race condition, especially on slow networks, the fix is always to implement a retry with jitter. That's a common mistake. Also, don't copy JWT tokens between staging and prod—they use different secrets! To debug, enable verbose logging with the `AUTH_DEBUG=1` flag; logs go straight to Datadog. I sent you all a Confluence page link for the SSO Integration Guide and the link to our main Auth Metrics dashboard."

New Engineer 2: "Got it. Is the architecture document in the same Confluence space?"

Marcus Chen: "Yes, the Auth Architecture doc is there. And the main code repo is `auth-service` on GitHub. I'll make sure the recording of this session is posted later today."

(Transcript End)